

such as *Akbar*, *Azad*, *Angadh*, *Virat*, *Sher-e-Punjab*, *Sahib*, *Sindh*, and *Sultan*, are all kept here with some that are operated for heritage runs.



▲ An antique valve gear model

Conserve and preserve

The conservation and preservation of railway heritage includes preliminary and detailed examinations, scientific as well as historical knowledge, funding, repairing, and maintenance. The actual restoration work may also have its own challenges. Sometimes, maintenance practices, artisanal skills, and traditional materials disappear with an older generation, making it tricky to replicate original designs. Old steam locomotives often have missing and broken parts, which require expertise to rebuild and recreate.

At times, modern equipment is added to ensure that they can operate. For instance, the Perambur Loco Works undertook the renovation of [EIR 21](#) and added advanced technological elements, such as a GPS-based speedometer.

There are several other instances of extensive reconstruction as well, especially for buildings, such as the East India Company (EIC)'s Burlington building, the oldest hospital in Asansol, West Bengal. It required extensive waterproofing of the roof, careful preservation of the old curved tiles, new electrical wiring, and even weatherproof painting.

For the people